

PATHSEEKER CAREER PASSPORT

Career Interview Preparation Pack

Research the role, build concise evidence stories, practice responsibly, and evaluate the employer as carefully as they evaluate you.

BEST FOR

Students, graduates, professionals, and career changers preparing for internships or job interviews.

FORMAT

8-page preparation pack - write directly on a printed copy or duplicate the prompts into your notes app.

Discover what fits you best - then test it with evidence.

01 - RESEARCH

Build a role brief

Prepare for the specific role and organization rather than memorizing generic answers.

Organization and customers	
Role outcomes in first 6-12 months	
Repeated skills in the description	
Likely team and collaborators	
Recent product, service, or market context	
Questions or risks to clarify	

My 30-second reason for this role...

02 - STORIES

Create an evidence bank

Use Situation, Task, Action, and Result as a structure, not a script. Emphasize your decisions and what you learned.

Problem solving		
Teamwork		
Communication		
Ownership		
Learning from failure		
Managing priorities		

Result

Use a measured outcome when available. If not, name the decision, delivery, feedback, or learning produced.

03 - BEHAVIORAL

Practice high-value questions

Answer aloud in one to two minutes. Then shorten without removing the decision or result.

- Tell me about a time you solved an ambiguous problem.
- Describe a disagreement and how you handled it.
- Tell me about feedback that changed your work.
- Describe a mistake, its impact, and what changed afterward.
- How have you prioritized when everything felt urgent?
- Tell me about a time you influenced without authority.
- What is a skill you learned recently, and how did you apply it?

The answer that needs the most practice...

04 - TECHNICAL OR CASE

Prepare for a work sample

Clarify the goal and constraints before solving. Think aloud selectively so the interviewer can follow your reasoning.

- [] Restate the problem and desired outcome.
- [] Ask about users, data, constraints, and success criteria.
- [] Name assumptions.
- [] Outline an approach before diving into detail.
- [] Check edge cases, risks, or accessibility.
- [] Validate the answer where possible.
- [] Summarize tradeoffs and the next step.

05 - EVALUATE

Ask better questions

Use your questions to understand expectations, support, ethics, and the reality behind the job description.

- [] What outcome would make the first six months successful?
- [] What does a typical week look like?
- [] How does the team make and review decisions?
- [] How is feedback given, and how often?
- [] What support exists for learning and onboarding?
- [] What is the hardest unresolved challenge for this role?
- [] How does the organization handle accessibility, privacy, or safety relevant to the work?
- [] Why is the role open, and what changed recently?

My two role-specific questions...

06 - REHEARSE

Run a mock interview

Ask the reviewer to score observable qualities and record one actionable change per round.

Clear structure						
Specific evidence						
Relevant detail						
Honest limitations						
Concise delivery						
Thoughtful questions						

One change for the next practice round...

07 - READY

Interview-day checklist

Reduce avoidable friction so you can focus on the conversation.

- ☐ Confirm time, time zone, format, and participants.
- ☐ Test camera, audio, internet, screen sharing, and charging.
- ☐ Keep the job description, resume, portfolio, notes, and water ready.
- ☐ Prepare a quiet and accessible environment or request accommodations.
- ☐ Join or arrive 5-10 minutes early.
- ☐ Pause before answering and ask for clarification when needed.
- ☐ Do not disclose confidential information from previous work.
- ☐ Send a concise follow-up and record what you learned.

Follow-up note: interest, relevant takeaway, and next step...

Sources and responsible use

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics - Occupational Outlook Handbook

Occupation duties, education, 2024 pay, and 2024-2034 outlook reference data.

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/>

O*NET OnLine

Detailed occupation tasks, knowledge, skills, work activities, and technology examples.

<https://www.onetonline.org/>

CareerOneStop

Career exploration, training, job-search, and local salary research tools.

<https://www.careeronestop.org/>

Important

Career requirements, salaries, and hiring practices vary by country, city, employer, experience, and economic conditions. Use occupational data as a research starting point, not a promise of employment or pay.